V-L-61e
April 25, 1967
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. V-L-61d
February 20, 1963

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

LACES, NYLON

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal Agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers two types of nylon laces.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Types and classes. Laces shall be of two types in the following classes, as specified (6.2).

Type I—Spun nylon laces.
Class 1—7/32 inch width, flat.
Class 2—10/32 inch width, flat.

Type II—Bulked filament nylon laces.
Class 1—3/32 inch diameter, round.
Class 2—8/32 inch width, flat.
Class 3—4/32 inch diameter, round.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

UU-P-268—Paper, Kraft, Untreated, Wrapping.
CCC-T-191—Textile Test Methods.
PPP-B-636—Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-T-45—Tape, Gummed, Paper, Reinforced and Plain, for Sealing and Securing.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105—Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

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3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Guide sample. Samples, when furnished, are solely for guidance and information to the supplier (6.3). Variations from this specification may appear in the sample, in which case this specification shall govern.

3.2 Preproduction sample. When specified (see 6.2), before production is commenced, twenty finished laces shall be submitted or made ready for the contracting officer or his authorized representative for inspection as specified in 4.2. The approval of the preproduction sample authorizes the commencement of production but does not relieve the supplier of responsibility for compliance with all applicable provisions of this specification. The preproduction sample shall be manufactured in the same facilities to be used for the manufacture of the production items.

3.3 Material.

3.3.1 Nylon. The use of regenerated or reprocessed nylon is prohibited. The supplier shall certify that the laces have been manufactured from virgin nylon.

3.3.2 Yarn. The nylon yarn for braiding type I, classes 1 and 2 laces shall be spun from nylon staple and twisted into a 2-ply yarn. The nylon yarn for braiding type II, classes 1 and 2 laces, shall be a 210 denier filament yarn which has been increased in size to 230–250 denier by air bulking. The cover yarns and warp yarns for braiding type II, class 3 laces shall be made from 840 denier high tenacity filament nylon yarn which has been increased to 940–1000 denier by the air bulking process; and the stuffer shall be one end of 10,080 denier, high tenacity filament nylon yarn, which is not air bulked. The stuffer shall not be braided.

3.3.3 Tips. The tips shall be made from nylon sheet or film having a thickness of .013 to .016 inch. The color of the tips shall be black for black laces, and clear for all other colored laces. As an alternate, the tips of type II, class 3 laces may be heat molded.

3.4 Color. The color of the finished laces shall be as specified (see 6.2) except the stuffer yarn for type II, class 3 lace need not be dyed.

3.4.1 Color matching. The color shall match the standard sample under natural (north sky) daylight, or artificial daylight having a color temperature of 7500° Kelvin and shall be a good approximation to the standard sample under incandescent lamplight at 2800° Kelvin.

3.4.2 Colorfastness. The dyed laces shall show colorfastness to water equal to, or better than, the standard sample when tested as specified in 4.3.2.2. When no standard sample is available, the dyed laces shall show "good" colorfastness to water when tested as specified in 4.3.2.2.

3.5 Braid. The braid for the laces shall be tubular braided without a core except for type II, class 3 which has a stuffer core. All laces shall use a two over and two under braiding except type II, class 2 which shall braid one pair over and one pair under. The braid shall be pressed flat for type I, classes 1 and 2, and for type II, class 2 laces in accordance with commercial practice. The braid for type II, classes 1 and 3 laces shall not be pressed and shall be round. The braid for the laces shall conform to the physical requirements in table I when tested as specified in 4.3.2.2.

TABLE I. Physical requirements

Type	Class	Width (Tol. ±1/32) inch	Carriers minimum	Ends per carrier minimum	Warp ends minimum	Stuffer minimum	Picks per inch minimum	Breaking strength (lbs) minimum
I	1	7/32	44	1	—	—	38	95
I	2	10/32	44	2	—	—	26	175
II	1	3/32 (diam.)	16	3	—	—	28	100
II	2	8/32	44 [1]	2	—	—	17	190
II	3	4/32 (diam.)	8	2	4	1	16	180

[1] Carriers braiding in pairs.

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3.6 Tipping. Both ends of the braid shall be provided with a firmly attached and secured tip made from the material specified in 3.3.3. As an alternate for type II, class 1 and 3 laces, heat molded tips are permitted. Tips shall be $\frac{3}{4} \pm \frac{1}{16}$ inch long.

3.6.1 Gripping strength. The nylon tips made from nylon sheet or film shall have a minimum gripping strength of 25 pounds for classes 1 and 3 laces and 40 pounds for class 2 laces when subjected to the test specified in 4.3.2.2.

3.6.2 Compression strength. The tips made from nylon sheet or film shall not be cracked, dislodged from their position, or peeled from the lace when tested as specified in 4.3.2.2.

3.7 Length. Laces shall be furnished in lengths, including tips, as specified (see 6.2). The laces shall be cut so as to insure the specified length when tested as specified in 4.3.2.2. Laces under 40 inches shall have a length tolerance of plus 5 percent, and laces 40 inches and longer shall have a length tolerance of plus 3 percent.

3.8 Workmanship. The finished laces shall conform to the quality and grade of product established by this specification. Occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Certificate of compliance. Where certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to check test such items to determine the validity of the certification.

4.2 Preproduction sample inspection. When required, the preproduction sample submitted in accordance with 3.2 shall be inspected as specified in 4.3.2.1, 4.3.2.1.1, 4.3.2.1.2, and 4.3.2.1.3 for compliance with material construction, workmanship and dimensional requirements. The sample shall be tested for physical and chemical characteristics in accordance with 4.3.2.2.

4.3 Inspection. Inspection shall be in accordance with the provisions of MIL–STD–105 except when otherwise indicated.

4.3.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1 above, components and materials shall be tested in accordance with all requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase documents. In addition, testing shall be performed on components listed in table II for the characteristics shown. The inspection level for each component shall be level S–1 and the acceptable quality level (AQL) for each component shall be 6.5 test failures per hundred units. All requirements are applicable to the sample unit. When the data in the "Number of determinations per sample unit" and "Results reported as" columns are not specified in table II, they shall be as required by the referenced test method.

TABLE II. Component tests

Component and lot expressed in terms of	Characteristic	Requirement paragraph	Test method	Number of determinations per sample unit	Results reported as	Sample unit
Nylon sheet (10 sheets)	Thickness	3.3.3	Gauge	3	Average of 3 determinations to the nearest 0.001 inch	6 by 1½ inch piece or equivalent

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TABLE II. Component tests (con'd)

Component and lot expressed in terms of	Characteristic	Requirement paragraph	Test method	Number of determinations per sample unit	Results reported as	Sample unit
Nylon sheet (10 sheets) (cont'd)	Material identification	3.3.3	[3]	1	Pass or fail	
Nylon yarn Type II, before & after air bulking (1 cone, tube or spool of each)	Filament	3.3.2	Visual	1	Pass or fail	1 cone, spool or tube of each
	Denier [1] [2]	3.3.2	4021 of CCC-T-191	—	—	

[1] The supplier shall certify that a 210 denier filament yarn was used prior to air bulking for type II, classes 1 and 2 laces.
[2] The supplier shall certify that an 840 denier filament yarn was used prior to air bulking for type II, class 3.
[3] The supplier shall submit a certificate of compliance for this characteristic. The certificate shall be accompanied by actual test, inspection or other verifiable quality data.

4.3.2 Inspection of the end item.

4.3.2.1 Examination of the end item. The laces shall be examined for defects in workmanship, material, overall width or diameter, and overall length of tips. Defects found during these examinations shall be classified in accordance with 4.3.2.1.1, 4.3.2.1.2, and 4.3.2.1.3. The sample unit for these examinations shall be one completely finished lace, and the lot size shall be expressed in units of one lace each.

4.3.2.1.1 Examination for material and workmanship. The inspection level for this examination shall be level I and the AQL shall be 1.0 defect per hundred units.

Examine	Defect
Laces	Any broken yarn. Frayed. Rub or abrasion marks. Hole, cut or tear. Unevenly braided resulting in open place or break in continuity of braid. Pulled yarn or uneven tension resulting in uneven width. Other than tubular braided with a core, when applicable. Other than tubular braided without a core, when applicable. Flat lace, when applicable, not flat for a distance of 2 inches or more. Round lace, when applicable, not round for a distance of 2 inches or more. Slub, knot, or abruptly thickened place which may affect utility. Color other than specified. Offshade. Spot, stain, or other discoloration affecting appearance. Objectionable odor.
Tipping	Any tip missing, damaged, malformed, or insecurely attached. Tipping of braid not neatly accomplished. Not fabricated of nylon sheet, when applicable. Color—clear or any color other than black for black laces. Color—any color other than clear for laces other than black. End of tip projects beyond the braid more than 1/16 inch (for attached tips only). End of braid projects beyond the tip end more than 1/16 inch (for attached tips only).

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4.3.2.1.2 Examination for width or diameter. Any width or diameter, measured in accordance with 4.4.1, that exceeds the tolerance of table I shall be classified a defect. The inspection level for this examination shall be S–3 and the AQL shall be 1.0 defect per hundred units.

4.3.2.1.3 Examination for overall length of tip ends. Any overall length of tip exceeding specified tolerances indicated in 3.6 shall be classified as a defect. The inspection level for this examination shall be S–3 and the AQL shall be 1.0 defect per hundred units.

4.3.2.2 Testing of the end item. Testing of the completely fabricated laces shall be performed in accordance with table III and CCC–T–191 for characteristics shown therein. The inspection level shall be S–1 and the AQL shall be 6.5 test failures per hundred units. The sample unit for tests shall be twenty completely fabricated laces. Requirements are applicable to the sample unit. When the data in the "Number of determinations per sample unit" and "Results reported as" columns are not specified in table III, they shall be as required by the referenced test method. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one lace each.

TABLE III. End item tests

Characteristic	Requirement paragraph	Test method	Number of determinations per sample unit	Results reported as
Nylon identification [1]	3.3.1	1530	—	—
Yarn ply (type I)	3.3.2	Visual	1	Number of plies
Staple (type I)	3.3.2	Visual	1	Pass or fail
Colorfastness to water	3.4.2	4630	—	—
Braiding type	3.5	Visual	1	Pass or fail
Gripping strength (tips)	3.6.1	4.4.5	—	—
Compression strength (tips)	3.6.2	4.4.4	1	Pass or fail
Ends per carrier	Table I	Visual	1	Number of ends
Carriers	Table I	Visual	1	Number of carriers
Stuffer (type II, class 3)	Table I	Visual	1	Pass or fail
Picks per inch	Table I	Visual	1	Number of picks
Warp ends (type II, class 3)	Table I	Visual	1	Number of warp ends
Breaking strength	Table I	4102 and 4.4.3	—	—
Length, overall	3.7	4.4.2	1	To the nearest 1/16 inch

[1] The supplier shall submit a certificate of compliance for these characteristics. The certificate shall be accompanied by actual test, inspection or other verifiable quality data.

4.3.3 Examination of preparation for delivery requirements. An examination shall be made to determine that packaging, packing, and marking requirements of section 5 of this specification are complied with. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container, fully prepared for delivery with the exception that it need not be sealed. Defects of closure listed below shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S–2 and the AQL shall be 2.5 defects per hundred units.

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, improper taping, inadequate stapling.
	Bulged or distorted container.
Content	Number of bundles per container is more or less than required.
	Number of laces per bundle is more or less than required.[1]

[1] One bundle from each shipping container in the sample shall be examined.

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4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 Width or diameter. The width or diameter shall be determined at 3 points at least 9 inches apart by a steel rule graduated in thirty-seconds of an inch, or by a caliper-type gauge and the results averaged. The measurements shall be taken with the test lace suspended vertically under a tension of 3 ounces for classes 1 and 3, and 6 ounces for class 2 laces.

4.4.2 Length. The finished lace shall not be stretched or tensioned prior to the length test. The finished lace shall be suspended vertically under a tension of 3 ounces for classes 1 and 3, and 6 ounces for class 2, and then measured from end to end including tips.

4.4.3 Breaking strength. The breaking strength of the laces shall be determined as specified in CCC–T–191, method 4102, except that the clamps shall be not less than 2 inches in diameter and the distance between the center of the clamps at the start of the test shall be 6 inches $\pm 1/16$ inch. When the lace length is less than 24 inches, a flat-type jaw shall be used in lieu of a drum-type jaw.

4.4.4 Compression strength. The tip shall be placed between flat blocks of steel and subjected to a gradually applied crushing load of 1000 pounds.

4.4.5 Gripping strength of tips.

4.4.5.1 Test specimen. The specimen shall be a one-half length of a shoe lace. (Two determinations may be made from one complete shoe lace.)

4.4.5.2 Apparatus.

4.4.5.2.1 Testing machine. The testing machine shall be as described in method 5100, except a slotted metal plate as shown in figure 1 shall be used in connection with the top jaw assembly and the distance between the upper jaw (slotted metal plate) and the lower jaw or clamp shall be 4 inches $\pm 1/16$ inch. The lower jaw shall be as described in method 5100 or 4102 of CCC–T–191.

4.4.5.2.2 Metal plate (figure 1). The rigid metal plate shall be of the approximate dimensions 5 inches long by $1\frac{1}{2}$ inches wide and shall contain a 4-inch tapered slot centered widthwise and running lengthwise from an inside dimension of $\frac{1}{32}$ inch in width, increasing to a width of $\frac{1}{4}$ inch at the outside edge. The slot shall be smoothly finished. It is not required that the plate be of a single piece of metal. The slot may be formed by a clamped or bolted assembly of two metal bars or plates properly spaced apart. The plate shall be supported in a horizontal position in, or on, top jaw of the apparatus.

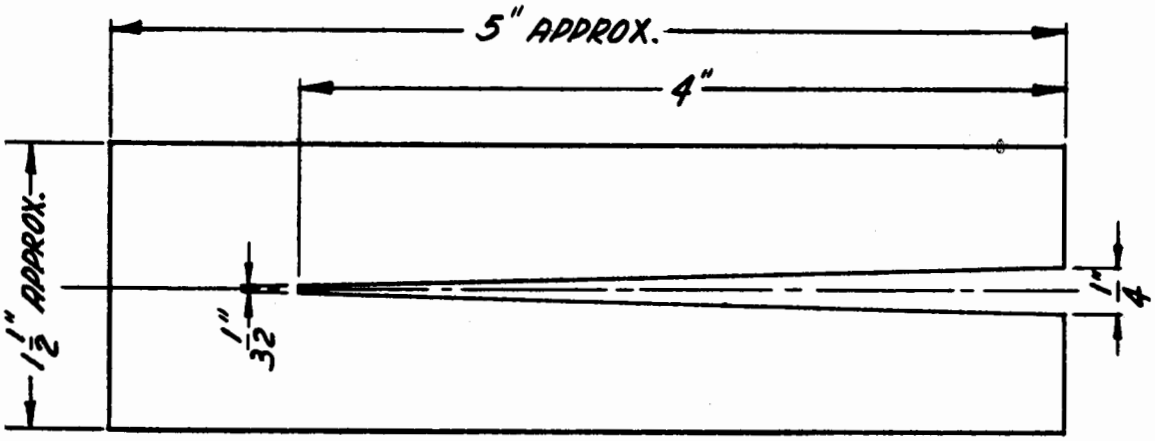


Figure 1. Slotted metal plate.

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4.4.5.3 Procedure. The lace shall be passed upward, tip first, through the jaw assembly and through the wide end of the slot until the tip clears the plate, and then moved horizontally toward the narrow end of the slot until the end of the tip rests on top of the metal plate. The free end of the specimen (lace) shall be fastened in the lower jaw or clamp. The machine shall be started, with the pawl in contact with the ratchet, and the maximum resistance in displacing the tip shall be recorded. The force shall be applied to the specimen at such a rate that the pulling clamp will travel at a uniform speed of 12 inches ± 0.5 inch per minute. After the tip has been forced from the lace, the resultant force shall be read from the dial, scale, or chart and the value recorded to the nearest pound. If the lace tip slips through the slot without its being removed from the lace or if, for any reason attributed to faulty technique, an individual measurement falls markedly below the average test for the sample unit, such result shall be discarded and another specimen shall be tested. Buckling of the tip material at the base of the tip without the tip being removed from the lace shall not be considered as a failure of the tip.

4.4.5.4 Report. Ten specimens shall be tested from each sample unit. The gripping strength of the sample unit shall be the average of the results and shall be reported to the nearest 1.0 pound.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C, as specified (6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Five gross of laces of one type, class, length, and color only shall be put-up in a compact bundle having approximate overall dimensions as specified in table IV. Prior to bundling the laces shall be grouped full length in one-gross lots and securely tied together. Each bundle of laces shall be completely wrapped in 60-pound-minimum basis-weight kraft paper conforming to grade B of UU-P-268. The wrap shall be securely sealed with 2-inch minimum-width gummed paper tape conforming to type III, grade B of PPP-T-45.

5.1.2 Level C. Laces shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against physical damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. The supplier may use his standard practice when it meets this requirement.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Laces of one type, class, length and color only, packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, V2s of PPP-B-636. Level A packages shall be packed in the quantities and arrangement as specified in table IV. Approximate inside dimensions of each shipping container shall be as specified in table IV. Each shipping container shall be closed, waterproofed, and reinforced with flat strapping or tape banding in accordance with the appendix of the container specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Laces of one type, class, length, and color only, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, type CF or SF, class domestic, variety SW, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Level A packages shall be packed in the quantities and arrangement as specified in table IV. Approximate inside dimensions of each shipping container shall be as specified in table IV. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of the container specification.

5.2.2.1 When specified, shipping containers shall be fabricated from V3c or V3s fiberboard (see 6.2).

5.2.3 Level C. Laces, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. Containers shall be in accordance with rules or regulations of carriers applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers, shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military requirements. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

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TABLE IV. Packing details

Class	Length, inches	Bundle [1]	Arrangement in container				Shipping container [1] Inside dimensions (inches)		
		Overall dimensions, inches	Quantity	Length	Width	Depth	Length	Width	Depth
1	21	10½ by 7½ by 3½	16	2	2	4	21	15	14¼
1	25	12½ by 7½ by 3½	16	2	2	4	27	15	14¼
1	27	13½ by 7½ by 3½	16	2	2	4	27	15	14¼
1	28½	14½ by 7½ by 3½	16	2	2	4	30	15	14¼
1	30	15 by 7½ by 3½	16	2	2	4	30	15	14¼
1	40	10 by 15 by 3½	16	2	2	4	30	20	14¼
1	50	25 by 7½ by 3½	8	1	2	4	27	15	14¼
1	52	26 by 7½ by 3½	8	1	2	4	27	15	14¼
1	54	27 by 7½ by 3½	8	1	2	4	27	15	14¼
1	84	21 by 15 by 3½	8	2	1	4	30	21	14¼
2	30	15 by 7½ by 7	8	2	2	2	30	15	14¼
2	40	10 by 15 by 7	8	2	2	2	30	20	14¼
2	44	11 by 15 by 7	8	2	2	2	30	22	14¼
2	52	26 by 7½ by 7	4	1	2	2	27	15	14¼
2	60	30 by 7½ by 7	4	1	2	2	30	15	14¼
2	64	16 by 15 by 7	4	2	1	2	30	16	14¼
3	60	30 by 7½ by 7	4	1	2	2	30	15	14¼

[1] Bundle and container dimensions are approximations and are furnished as a guide only.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The nylon laces covered by this specification are intended for use on various types of footwear, clothing, and equipage.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type, class, and length required (1.2 and 3.7).
(c) When preproduction sample is required (3.2).
(d) Color required (3.4).
(e) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (5.1 and 5.2).
(f) Whether V-board shipping containers are required for level B shipments (5.2.2.1).

6.3 Sample. For access to samples, address the procuring office issuing the invitation for bids.

6.4 For civil agencies level B packing should be used by ordering agencies only when shipment is known to be made to a holding supply depot or warehouse from which partial shipments will be made to ultimate consumers.

6.5 The requirements in 5.1.1 shall apply when level B packaging is specified for civil agency procurements.

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Preparing activity:
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SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

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INSTRUCTIONS

This sheet is to be filled out by personnel either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity.

SPECIFICATION

Laces, Nylon - V-L-61e

ORGANIZATION	CITY AND STATE

CONTRACT NO.	QUANTITY OF ITEMS PROCURED	DOLLAR AMOUNT
		$

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO IF "YES", IN WHAT WAY?

4. REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity)*	DATE

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